2. To lay down the procedure to be followed by its disciplinary committee and the disciplinary committee of each SBC
3. To safeguard the rights, privileges, and interests of advocates
4. To promote and support law reform
5. To deal with and dispose of any matter which is referred to it by a SBC
6. To exercise general supervision and control over SBCs
7. To promote legal education and to lay down standards of legal education in consultation with the Universities in India imparting legal education and the SBCs
8. To recognise universities whose degree in law shall be a qualification for enrolment as an advocate and for that purpose to visit and inspect universities. The BCI can also cause the SBCs to visit and inspect universities in accordance with the directions issued by it
9. To conduct seminars and organise talks on legal topics by eminent jurists and publish journals and papers of legal interest
10. To organise legal aid to the poor people
11. To recognise (on a reciprocal basis) foreign qualifications in law obtained outside India for the purpose of admission as an advocate under this Act
12. To manage and invest its funds
13. To provide for the election of its members.
14. To perform all other functions conferred on it under this Act
15. To do all other things necessary for discharging the above functions.

The BCI may establish funds for the following purposes:

1. Giving financial assistance to organize welfare schemes for indigent, disabled or other advocates
2. Giving legal aid or advice
3. Establishing law libraries

Further, the BCI may also receive grants, donations, gifts, and benefactions for the above purposes.

The BCI can become a member of international legal bodies such as the International Bar Association or the International Legal Aid Association.

State Bar Councils

1. Establishment

The Advocates Act, 1961 provides for the establishment of a SBC for each state or a common SBC for two or more states or for a state and a union territory.